

Introduction to HTML

What is HTML?

HTML stands for “*HyperText Markup Language*”. It is the standard markup language used to create and structure content on web pages.

HTML tells a web browser how different parts of a webpage should be displayed, such as:

- Headings
- Paragraphs
- Images
- Links
- Tables
- Forms
- Lists
- Videos

Brief History of HTML

HTML was created by ‘**Tim Berners-Lee**’ in the early **1990s** while working at CERN.

A brief timeline:

- 1991: The first version of HTML was introduced.
- 1995: HTML 2.0 became a standard.
- 1997: HTML 3.2 was released.
- 1999: HTML 4.01 became widely used.
- 2014: HTML5 became an official W3C recommendation.
- Today: HTML continues to evolve as a living standard and is an essential technology of the modern web.

HTML works with **CSS** for Styling and **JavaScript** for Interactivity

What are HTML Tags?

HTML **tags** are special keywords written inside angle brackets “< >”. They tell the browser what type of content is being represented.

Examples:

```
<p>This is a paragraph.</p>
```

Types of HTML Tags

1. Paired Tags (Opening & Closing)

These tags have both an opening and a closing tag.

Example: `<p>Hello World</p>`

2. Empty Tags (No Closing Tag)

These tags do not need a closing tag because they contain no content.

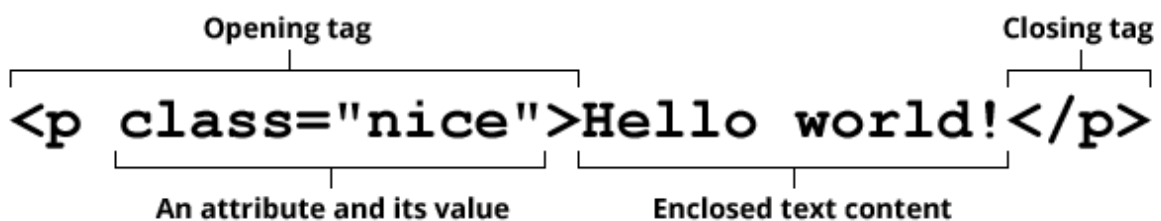
Example: `<br>`

What are HTML Elements?

An **HTML element** generally consists of an opening tag, content, and a closing tag. Elements are the building blocks of an HTML document.

Example: `<p>Hello World!</p>`

Anatomy of an HTML element



Difference Between a Tag and an Element

TAG	ELEMENTS
Tags are special keywords written inside <>	An element is the complete structure formed using HTML tags.
Tags tell the browser how to identify or structure content.	Elements contain the opening tag, content, and closing tag.
Tags can be opening or closing tags.	Elements can contain text, attributes, or other elements.
Tags are the building parts of an HTML	Elements represent the complete HTML

element.	component.
Example: <code><h1></code> and <code></h1></code>	Example: <code><h1>My Website</h1></code>

What are Attributes?

Attributes provide additional information about an HTML element. Attributes are written inside the opening tag.

Example: `<a href="https://example.com">Visit Website</a>`

- > `<a>` → HTML tag
- > `href` → Attribute
- > `"https://example.com"` → Attribute value

The `src` and `alt` are attributes of the `<img>` element

Common HTML attributes include:

- id
- class
- href
- src
- alt
- title
- style

Why is HTML Important in Web Development?

HTML is important because it provides the **basic structure of every webpage**

HTML allows developers to:

- > Create the structure of web pages.
- > Organize text and other content.
- > Add images, links, videos, and forms.
- > Make content understandable to web browsers.
- > Improve accessibility and semantic structure.
- > Work together with CSS and JavaScript to create complete websites.

Conclusion

HTML is the **foundation of the web**. It provides the **structure and meaning** of webpage content. By learning **HTML tags, elements, and attributes**, we can begin creating websites and move on to more advanced technologies such as **CSS** and JavaScript.